



CHHETRI & CO. AWAIT THE HAMZA CHALLENGE

Football fever gripped Shillong, the quaint capital of Meghalaya, with the prospect of an intense contest between old rivals India and Bangladesh.

Dubbed the South-Asian football derby, the Group C league fixture of the final round qualifiers for the Asian Cup 2027 seems to have relived the antagonism the two teams have shared for more than four decades. It has also greatly helped rekindle the dying embers of the rivalry between the two neighbouring nations.

With a berth in the final stage of the premier continental competition at stake, both teams have tried to put their best foot forward and secure an early advantage.

Bangladesh strengthened its squad with the inclusion of Leicester City player Hamza Choudhury (left), who recently got a nod from FIFA to alter his international allegiance. The 27-year-old defensive midfielder from Loughborough, England, obtained a Bangladeshi passport in

India recalling Sunil Chhetri and Bangladesh including Hamza Choudhury in its squad has greatly helped **rekindle** the dying embers of the footballing rivalry between the two neighbouring nations.